

Shared prompt in every arm

Each row is a separate polling case, not a time series. Positive net news favors the candidate and negative net news harms the candidate. Poll change is the ending poll minus the starting poll. Within a city, typical responsiveness to net news is stable across cases, although individual end polls remain noisy. Rows with the same Pair label have equal-sized news in opposite directions.

Query: A new City C case begins with a poll of 53.9 and has net news +5. What poll do you predict at the end of this new case? Think carefully about the expected poll, but do not provide step-by-step working. Respond with one JSON object only: {"rationale": "one short sentence", "predicted_poll": <number from 0 to 100>}

Illustrated arm: References + target context

CITY A

Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through **national news coverage**, where campaign stories receive sustained attention and tend to produce larger immediate poll movements.

Pair	Start	News	Delta	End
1	45.4	-8	-6.5	38.9
1	45.4	+8	+12.2	57.6
2	55.1	-6	+0.9	56.0
2	55.1	+6	+11.4	66.5

CITY B

Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through **local news coverage**, where campaign stories compete with local issues and tend to produce smaller immediate poll movements.

Pair	Start	News	Delta	End
1	35.0	-10	-5.6	29.4
1	35.0	+10	+9.3	44.3
2	51.8	-10	-5.5	46.3
2	51.8	+10	+7.2	59.0

CITY C - TARGET CONTEXT

Background: City C residents generally encounter campaign developments through **national news coverage**.

Pair	Start	News	Delta	End
1	57.8	+8	+9.4	67.2
1	57.8	-8	-1.8	56.0
2	47.4	+10	+8.1	55.5
2	47.4	-10	-10.6	36.8